IT HAS A NAME · MANAGEMENT MADE SIMPLE

PILLAR 6.3 · LEADERSHIP AS DESIGN
EXECUTION AND PROCESS

STRATEGIC MEETINGS

A strategic meeting is not a long meeting, it is a meeting that chooses.

What it decides, who joins and how to leave it with a choice.

> AND THE CONSEQUENCE
>
> If it ends without a decision that changes where the money and the team go, it was just an expensive conversation.

THE CASCADE

How the strategic meeting turns into a status update.

WHAT YOU SEE

The leadership team meets once a quarter and opens with each area's results...

THE MECHANISM

...the afternoon goes into numbers that fit on a dashboard, and the big topic is left for the end...

THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the decision on the new market becomes one more round of let us dig deeper.

> Whoever spends the strategic meeting on the quarter that passed does not decide the quarter ahead.

THE FORK

Is this topic for the strategic meeting?

THE RULER

01

Does it change where the company is going, which market, which product, which model? It belongs in the strategic.

02

Does it commit money or people for more than a year? It belongs in the strategic.

03

Does it adjust the plan for the coming weeks? Back to the tactical.

> If the decision can be undone next week, it did not need the leadership team.

THE METHOD

The Crossroads, four steps to the choice.

01 **QUESTION**

one or two decisions per meeting, written ahead in the invite

02 **SCENARIO**

data, market and options in writing, read by everyone before the debate

03 **CLASH**

the facilitator draws out disagreement, nobody agrees out of fatigue

04 **CHOICE**

the path, what stops being done, the owner and the date it goes down to the tactical

> A firm facilitator is not the one who decides. It is the one who does not let the room leave without deciding.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Half a day, four questions.

01 · QUESTION

Which decision has to come out of this room today?

written in the invite, two per meeting at most

02 · SCENARIO

What do the data and the market say about each path?

a memo read in silence in the first minutes, the way Amazon does it

03 · CLASH

Who thinks differently, and why?

disagreement comes before the decision, not in the hallway afterwards

04 · CHOICE

What do we choose, what do we drop and who takes it to the tactical?

a path with an owner, an explicit trade off and a date to go down

TWO MODELS

A long meeting or a meeting that chooses.

THE COMMON MODEL

The status strategic meeting

Opens with each area's results

Ten topics on the agenda, none of them explored

Whoever disagrees stays quiet so as not to slow things down

Ends with let us let the idea mature

THE DESIGNED MODEL

The choice strategic meeting

Opens with the question that needs an answer

One or two topics, with the scenario read ahead

Disagreement is drawn out before the decision

Ends with a path, a trade off, an owner and a date

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

What a strategic meeting without a choice costs.

01 The window.

→ the market does not wait for the next quarterly meeting to change.

02 Tactics in the dark.

→ with no direction decided, managers adjust the plan in every direction.

03 Leadership credibility.

→ the team learns that big decisions always get left for later.

> Not deciding is also a decision. It is just that nobody signs it.

THE CHAIN

The headline test.

01 At the end of the strategic meeting, ask each person to write the headline of what was decided.

↓

02 Compare the headlines. They need to state the same path and the same trade off.

↓

03 If the headlines differ, or nobody writes one, the meeting talked but did not choose.

↑

WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Read the headline out at the first weekly after the strategic meeting. That is how the decision comes down.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves for your next strategic meeting.

STEP 01

Write in the invite the decision that has to come out.

if there are more than two, split them into another meeting

STEP 02

Send the scenario in writing three days ahead.

and set aside the first minutes for reading in silence

STEP 03

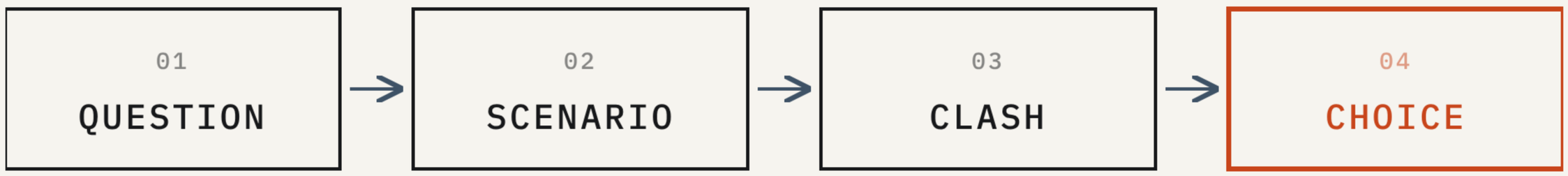
Close with the headline, the owner and the date it goes down.

the decision makes the agenda of the next tactical meeting, not just the minutes

> Take status out of the strategic meeting. Area numbers fit on a dashboard, not in the leadership team's afternoon.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Crossroads, in the order that matters.



Strategy is not talking about the future. It is choosing one path and dropping the others.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

before you send the invite for your next strategic meeting.

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